

BIRMINGHAM CLAUDE IMPACT LAB

CHALLENGE 4 • HOMELESSNESS HANDOFF

What happens now?

Birmingham publishes eleven cooling stations. Finding out whether one is open today is the hard part.

— A worked example, not a model answer



Marcus

Mid-fifties. Sleeping behind a shuttered storefront off 2nd Avenue North.

He is not in anyone's system. He needs somewhere cool for a few hours.

SCEN-01, from the event's synthetic dataset. The person is invented; the addresses are real.

TIME

11:14 AM

HEAT INDEX

99°F

STANDING NEXT TO HIM

An outreach volunteer with a phone, a pen, and ten minutes.

She needs one thing: where can he go right now that is actually open.

Three things that list does not tell you

95°

Whether they are open

They open only when the heat index hits 95°F. An activation can start later in the day.

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Who to call

The city publishes no phone number for any of the eleven. Nothing to dial before you send someone.

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Who it serves

Only one station's eligibility is published anywhere, and not by the city. Pathways serves women and children only. Marcus is a man in his fifties.

211

reaches a person, so everything routes there. But its own heat guidance lists no Birmingham addresses, and the county trail behind it goes cold.

A LIVE WALKTHROUGH — SWITCHING TO THE ARTIFACT NOW

What we built

A handoff card that produces nothing until a person has confirmed a station is open, and a blank you print beforehand and fill in by hand on the street.

THREE THINGS TO WATCH FOR

It refuses to help too early

No handoff until someone has called and written down what they were told.

A dead end is an answer

Not activated, or nobody could confirm?
No card at all.

Eligibility rides along

Pick Pathways. Watch where the restriction lands on the card handed over.

BEFORE ANYONE PILOTS THIS

Considerations & Limitations

IT GOES STALE

A snapshot from one day. Nothing here tells you when it stopped being true.

GETTING THERE IS UNSOLVED

Nothing we found says how a person reaches a station. A confirmed address two miles away, on foot, at 99°F, is not a plan.

NIGHTS ARE UNCOVERED

The latest close is 8 p.m., and that is two libraries on Tuesdays. Ten of eleven shut by 6, one at 12:30. Sundays, only two open at all.

IT NEEDS PEOPLE

The gate works because a person makes the call. Volunteers cap how many handoffs happen during an advisory.

ENTRY RULES ARE UNKNOWN

No source states an ID or residency rule, and none rules one out. The card never claims “no ID needed” on its own authority.

Marcus is invented, and so is the hour, the temperature, the street and the volunteer. The eleven stations and their hours are real, cited on slide 3.

Give it to one outreach team for a week of heat advisories

THEN ASK THEM ONE QUESTION

Did the person arrive, and was the building open when they got there?

Nothing else tells you whether the gate does any good. Until someone runs that week, this is a guess.

TWO CHEAPER ASKS

Ask the city to publish a phone number for each station. Their absence is why this detours through 211.

Ask 211 whether it gets the city's activation notices. We could not confirm that it does.

Claude Code was used throughout: to research the sources, build the handoff card, and design this deck.

